

FACTS  
IDEAS  
INSIGHTS  
FOR A  
BRIGHTER  
TOMORROW

ClearExams

LEARN TODAY LEAD TOMORROW

Small  
Updates  
Big Picture

# CURRENT AFFAIRS

DAILY DIGEST



15 SEPTEMBER 2026



POLITY &  
GOVERNANCE



ECONOMY



INTERNATIONAL  
RELATIONS



ENVIRONMENT



SCIENCE &  
TECHNOLOGY



AGRICULTURE

STAY INFORMED  
STAY AHEAD

A  
MORE  
INFORMED  
A BRIGHTER  
TOMORROW



KNOW TODAY. BUILD TOMORROW.

# WORLD CIRCULAR ECONOMY FORUM 2026 OPENS IN GANDHINAGAR

PEOPLE | RESOURCES | A MORE RESILIENT TOMORROW



15 – 18  
September 2026



Gandhinagar,  
Gujarat, India

TOWARDS A  
RESOURCE-EFFICIENT  
AND SUSTAINABLE  
WORLD

Global ideas.  
Circular solutions.  
A cleaner,  
greener tomorrow.

## WHAT IS A CIRCULAR ECONOMY?

An economic model that reduces waste and resource extraction by designing products and systems around reuse, repair, refurbishment, remanufacturing and recycling.

IN CONTRAST, THE  
LINEAR MODEL FOLLOWS:

"Take – Make – Dispose"



## KEY CONCEPTS



**Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR)**  
Makes producers responsible for specified post-consumer waste management.



**Resource Efficiency**  
Creating greater economic value with lower material and energy inputs.



**SDG 12**  
Responsible Consumption and Production.

## WHY IT MATTERS FOR INDIA

- Resource security
- Lower waste generation
- Reduced material import dependence
- Industrial competitiveness
- Green jobs
- Climate mitigation
- Sustainable consumption and production

## A SHARED GLOBAL PLATFORM

- Brings together governments, industry, innovators and civil society
- Showcases circular economy approaches and India's initiatives on resource circularity
- Encourages knowledge exchange and collaboration for a sustainable future

CIRCULAR SOLUTIONS  
STRONGER PEOPLE  
CLEANER PLANET

RESOURCES CIRCULATE. OPPORTUNITIES GROW.

A CLEANER, GREENER, MORE  
RESILIENT TOMORROW

# GREAT INDIAN BUSTARD

## NEW SOFT-RELEASE CENTRE OPENS

### AT NALIYA, KACHCHH

GRASSLANDS  
TODAY  
BRIGHTER  
TOMORROW

A major step to strengthen conservation efforts for one of India's most threatened birds.



#### WHAT'S NEW?

A dedicated Great Indian Bustard soft-release centre has been inaugurated at Naliya in Kachchh, Gujarat (15 September 2026).

Three chicks rescued from Rajasthan will be reared here for about four to five months with minimal human intervention before their eventual release into the wild under established conservation protocols.

Conserving  
Tomorrow's  
Skies

#### WHAT IS SOFT RELEASE?

A conservation method in which captive-bred or rehabilitated animals spend a transition period in controlled or semi-natural conditions before full release, helping them adapt to the wild and improving their survival prospects.



A SAFER START  
FOR A WILDER TOMORROW

#### ABOUT GREAT INDIAN BUSTARD



Scientific name: *Ardeotis nigriceps*



IUCN status: Critically Endangered



Habitat: Grasslands and semi-arid regions



Major strongholds in India:  
Rajasthan and Kachchh, Gujarat



Major threats: Habitat loss and fragmentation, collision with overhead power lines

#### KEY HABITAT AREAS



#### CONSERVATION PROGRESS IN KACHCHH



~11 sq km  
of *Prosopis juliflora*-  
invaded grassland  
restored



~30 km  
predator-proof fencing  
covering 15 sq km



#### 'Jump-start' intervention

Infertile eggs laid by wild females are replaced with viable eggs from the conservation-breeding programme. A chick from a recent attempt survived beyond the critical first three months.

#### THE PATH FROM CAPTIVITY TO THE WILD



Conservation  
breeding



Soft-release  
centre (Naliya)



Acclimatisation  
with minimal  
human contact



Suitable  
habitat



Monitored  
release into the  
wild

Healthy Grasslands  
Support a Richer Tomorrow

PEOPLE  
CONSERVATION  
COEXISTENCE

# INDIAN RUPEE UNDER PRESSURE

BRENT CRUDE  
**\$107.7**  
per barrel  
(15 Sept 2026)

## AS OIL SURGES; RBI MOVES TO ABSORB LIQUIDITY

Rising crude prices and global factors weaken the rupee, while the RBI steps in to manage volatility and absorb excess liquidity.

OIL

OIL

### RUPEE HITS 1-MONTH LOW

**₹95.92**

per US dollar  
(15 Sept 2026)

Weakest level in  
more than a month



### WHY OIL PRICES ARE RISING



Attacks on Saudi energy infrastructure disrupted supplies



Brent crude rose to about  
**\$107.7** per barrel  
(15 Sept 2026)



Markets expect a US Federal Reserve rate hike, adding to global uncertainty

### IMPACT ON INDIA



India is a major oil importer



Higher crude prices can increase the import bill



Raising inflation risks and putting pressure on the rupee

### RBI'S RESPONSE



Using dollar sales through state-run banks to curb excessive currency volatility



Announced open-market bond sales totalling **₹1 trillion** in September 2026



**₹500 billion** sale scheduled for 15 September

These steps aim to absorb surplus rupee liquidity from the banking system.



### FOREIGN-EXCHANGE RESERVES

**~\$785 billion**

India's forex reserves (at a record high), providing a buffer against external volatility.



### 10-YEAR GOVT BOND YIELD

**~7.09%**

Rising bond yields reflect tighter financial conditions and global spillovers.



### KEY CONCEPTS



Currency depreciation means the rupee buys fewer US dollars.



Imported inflation occurs when a weaker currency and higher global commodity prices raise domestic costs.



Open Market Operations are RBI purchases or sales of government securities to inject or absorb liquidity. Selling government bonds absorbs rupee liquidity.



Forex intervention can moderate disorderly exchange rate movements but does not imply a fixed exchange rate.

### HOW IT ALL CONNECTS



A STABLE RUPEE SUPPORTS  
A STRONGER, MORE RESILIENT INDIA

# INDIA'S INFLATION ACCELERATES

AUGUST 2026: CPI 4.8% | WPI 9.9%



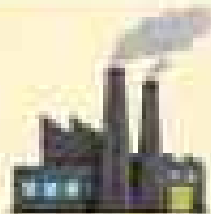
## RETAIL INFLATION (CPI)



**4.8%**  
in August 2026

- Highest since the new CPI series began in Jan 2026
- Food inflation rose to around 6%

## WHOLESALE INFLATION (WPI)



**9.9%**  
in August 2026

- Rose sharply, driven by higher commodity and input prices
- Reflects price changes at the wholesale level

## WHAT DO CPI AND WPI MEAN?

### CPI (Consumer Price Index)

- Measures changes in retail prices faced by consumers
- Main inflation gauge used for monetary-policy discussion
- Headline inflation includes all CPI components (food, fuel, etc.)
- Food inflation measures changes in food prices

### WPI (Wholesale Price Index)

- Tracks price changes at the wholesale level
- Basket is dominated by goods (lesser weight to services)
- Can move differently from CPI due to different baskets, weights and coverage

● 1 basis point (bps) = 0.01 percentage point

## HOW HIGHER PRICES TRANSMIT THROUGH THE ECONOMY



### MONETARY POLICY CONTEXT



- Rising inflation has increased market expectations of possible monetary tightening.
- Monetary policy aims to maintain price stability while keeping growth in mind.

### WHY CPI AND WPI CAN DIVERGE

- Different baskets and weights (e.g., services in CPI, goods heavy in WPI)
- Different stages of the supply chain (retail vs. wholesale)
- Different coverage and price collection methodologies
- Food and fuel shocks can impact WPI earlier and pass through to CPI over time.

HIGHER INFLATION HITS HOUSEHOLDS, BUSINESSES AND THE ECONOMY

# INDIA PREPARES PM-KUSUM 2.0 WITH AGRIVOLTAICS PUSH

Same Land  
More Possibilities



Union New and Renewable Energy Minister Pralhad Joshi said the government will launch a second edition of PM-KUSUM to enable farmers to generate renewable electricity alongside agricultural production.

Food and  
Energy Together  
for a Brighter Tomorrow

Power  
to Farmers  
Prosperity  
to Farmers



## WHAT IS AGRIVOLTAICS?

Co-locating solar photovoltaic panels and agriculture on the same land so that crops or other farm activities can continue while electricity is generated.



## ABOUT PM-KUSUM

The original PM-KUSUM scheme promotes decentralised solar energy in agriculture, including solar power plants and solar agricultural pumps, with goals such as lower irrigation-energy costs and additional income opportunities for farmers.



## PM-KUSUM 2.0 (ANNOUNCEMENT)

A second edition will be launched, with a dedicated **10 GW agri-photovoltaic component proposed**. Final operational details and scheme parameters are subject to government confirmation.

## HOW AGRIVOLTAICS WORKS



Farmland + elevated or appropriately spaced solar panels



Crops continue to grow below or between panels



Electricity generation



Power for farm use or grid supply



Potential additional farmer income



## KEY BENEFITS



Supplementary income for farmers



Renewable power generation



Lower fossil-fuel use and emissions



Productive dual land use



Decentralised renewable energy for rural areas



## KEY CHALLENGES



High upfront costs



Suitable panel height and spacing



Crop-specific effects on yield



Grid connectivity and evacuation



Maintenance and land-use design

Risk of groundwater over-extraction if pumping becomes cheaper



## GLOBAL FOCUS

Agrivoltaics World Conference 2026  
is scheduled in New Delhi for 21-23 October 2026.



Sustainable Farms  
Resilient Future

# INDIA'S AUGUST 2026 TRADE DEFICIT NARROWS

STRONGER  
TRADE  
= STRONGER  
INDIA

Lower gold imports help reduce the goods deficit;  
services exports remain strong

15 September 2026

Trade  
Connects  
India  
to the World



**MERCHANDISE EXPORTS**  
(August 2026)

**US\$ 43.81  
billion**



**MERCHANDISE IMPORTS**  
(August 2026)

**US\$ 70.67  
billion**



**MERCHANDISE  
TRADE DEFICIT**  
(August 2026)

**US\$ 26.86  
billion**

(vs US\$ 32 billion  
in July 2026)



**GOLD IMPORTS**

**US\$ 2.3 billion**

(vs US\$ 4.36 billion  
in July 2026)



**SERVICES EXPORTS**  
(August 2026)

**US\$ 38.87  
billion**



**SERVICES TRADE SURPLUS**  
(August 2026)

**US\$ 17.45  
billion**



**COMBINED GOODS &  
SERVICES EXPORTS**  
(August 2026)

**US\$ 82.68  
billion**



**~25%**  
(year-on-year)



**TOP EXPORT DESTINATION**  
(April–August 2026)



United States  
remained India's  
leading export  
destination

## WHAT IS A TRADE DEFICIT?

Occurs when merchandise imports  
exceed merchandise exports.



## THE BIGGER PICTURE

The Current Account includes  
trade in goods and services,  
plus primary and secondary income.

- A strong services surplus  
can partly offset the  
merchandise trade deficit  
in the overall external account.



## WHY GOLD IMPORTS MATTER?

Lower gold imports reduce  
pressure on the merchandise  
import bill.



## IMPACT OF HIGH CRUDE-OIL PRICES

Higher crude-oil prices can  
increase India's import bill,  
as India is a major oil importer.



## WHY THIS MATTERS?

- External-sector stability
- Rupee demand and supply
- Foreign-exchange needs
- Import dependence
- Export competitiveness
- Current-account dynamics

A Stronger External Sector  
Builds a Brighter India



COMPETITIVE  
INDIA  
CONNECTED  
INDIA  
PROSPEROUS  
INDIA

# INDIA – MERCOSUR

15 SEPT  
2026

## PTA EXPANSION TALKS LAUNCHED

India and MERCOSUR have formally launched negotiations to expand their existing Preferential Trade Agreement.



### WHAT IS A PREFERENTIAL TRADE AGREEMENT (PTA)?



- Participating countries reduce tariffs on a selected list of products.
- Unlike a full free trade agreement, tariffs are not necessarily eliminated across substantially all trade.

### INDIA – MERCOSUR PTA



- In place since 2009.
- Now, negotiations have been launched to expand the agreement with wider product coverage and deeper tariff preferences.

### WHY EXPANSION MATTERS FOR INDIA



Wider preferential market access in South America



Export diversification and deeper engagement with Latin America



Opportunities for pharmaceuticals, engineering goods, automobiles/auto components, chemicals, textiles and agricultural trade



Domestic sectors may also face greater import competition

### IMPORTANT CONCEPTS



**Preferential tariff**  
Lower tariff rate on agreed products for partner countries.



**Rules of origin**  
Criteria used to determine where a product originates and whether it qualifies for preferential tariff treatment.



**Trade diversification**  
Expanding exports to new markets and across a wider range of products.



**Regional trade agreement**  
Trade agreement among a group of countries in a region to promote trade and economic cooperation.

### PATH AHEAD



India + MERCOSUR negotiate wider product coverage and tariff preferences



Lower barriers on agreed goods



More trade and supply-chain links



Stronger economic ties between India and South America

FROM THE INDIAN OCEAN  
TO A STRONGER TOMORROW

# UK-INDIA TELECOM COOPERATION TO USE AI AGAINST DIGITAL FRAUD

Stronger networks. Safer users. A more secure digital future.



**MoU signed on  
14 September 2026**

Announced by the  
British High Commission  
in New Delhi on  
15 September 2026



## Who signed?

UK government and the  
Cellular Operators  
Association of India (COAI)

A Memorandum of Understanding  
to cooperate on artificial-  
intelligence-enabled telecom  
approaches to tackle online fraud,  
scams and digital harms.



## HOW AI HELPS IN TELECOM FRAUD DETECTION

- Analyses network patterns and unusual activity
- Identifies suspicious calls, messages and behaviour
- Helps detect and flag potential scam networks in real time
- Supports faster response by telecom operators and authorities



## TELECOM CYBERSECURITY

- Protects communications networks, services and users from digital threats
- Involves threat monitoring, fraud detection, network security and user protection
- Critical for safe digital payments, online services and an inclusive digital economy



## WHY CROSS-BORDER COOPERATION MATTERS

- Fraud networks, telecom routes and digital platforms often operate across countries
- Enables information and technical cooperation
- Helps deal with evolving and transnational cyber threats
- Builds shared expertise for a safer global digital ecosystem

## HOW THE COOPERATION WORKS



## OPPORTUNITIES

- Faster detection of suspicious activity
- Knowledge and best-practice sharing
- Improved fraud intelligence
- Safer digital payments and communications
- Supports a trusted and inclusive digital economy



## KEY CHALLENGES

- Privacy and data protection
- False positives and error risks
- Algorithmic accountability and transparency
- Cybersecurity and data misuse risks
- Jurisdictional issues in cross-border cases
- Need for responsible and ethical use of AI



## WHAT AN MoU MEANS

- A Memorandum of Understanding records a framework for cooperation and intent.
- It is generally not the same as a treaty and does not, by itself, create binding international legal obligations.
- Specific projects and actions will be taken forward through further discussions and agreements.